School of Media and Communication
Bowling Green, OH 43403

Informed Consent for First and Second-Generation Immigrant Pakistani Americans

Introduction of the Researcher

The principal investigator (PI), Saadia Farooq, is a PhD student in the School of Media and Communication at Bowling Green State University (BGSU). Under the guidance of her advisor, Dr. Sandra Faulkner, Professor of Media and Communication at BGSU, Saadia is conducting research focused on the identity development and negotiation of Pakistani immigrants and their U.S.-raised children.

Eligibility for Participation

Participants must be 18 years or older and meet specific migration status requirements. First-generation immigrants must have migrated from Pakistan to the U.S. and have children who grew up in the U.S. Second-generation immigrants must have been born in the U.S. or migrated at a young age with at least one parent being a first-generation immigrant from Pakistan.

Purpose of the Study

The purpose of this study is to look at Pakistani American family dynamics holistically from the perspective of everyone involved in the familial hierarchy of relationships, such as parents (mother and father) and adult children (daughters and sons) who are 18 years or older. This study investigates how parents, and their now grown-up (adult) children communicated topics that conflict with the cultural values parents carry and how the negotiation occurs while dealing with complex situations at various times while growing up. The experiences and stories of first-generation Pakistani migrant parents and their second-generation adult children. This study explores the

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challenges faced by first- and second-generation Pakistani American migrant families who came to the US to have a better lifestyle.

The study will investigate how these families navigate their identities inside and outside their homes and deal with difficult conversations using the communicated narrative sense-making theory and the communicated theory of identity.

Benefits of the Study:

There are no direct benefits to participating in this study. However, your participation may help to better understand the experiences and challenges faced by Pakistani immigrants, which could inform future support programs for this community. The benefits of this study include a deeper understanding of the challenges faced by first and second-generation Pakistani American immigrant families. This understanding can help develop effective interventions to promote healthy family communication and well-being of the community. Additionally, the research aims to fill the gaps in existing knowledge within the Critical Interpersonal Family Communication (CIFC) field, which can contribute to the development of more targeted and impactful support for these families.

Procedure:

Depending on your preference, you will participate in a recorded one-on-one interview, either in person or via a video conferencing platform. The interview will be recorded on BGSU servers using Zoom cloud, and the interview will be approximately 60–90 minutes. During this interview, you will be asked to reflect on your journey of arrival and settlement in the U.S. and your experience of parenting while adjusting to the new social environment. Example questions may include:

- Can you describe your initial experiences upon arriving in the United States?
- What were your primary motivations for immigrating to the U.S.?
- How did you and your family adapt to the new environment during the early years?

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- What were some of the biggest challenges you faced as a new immigrant?
- What was your sense of identity before moving to the U.S.? How did that change after you arrived?

If you chose online interview, please clear your browser history once you are done with the Zoom interview.

Voluntary:

Your participation is completely voluntary. You are free to withdraw at any time. You may decide to skip questions (or not do a particular task) or discontinue participation at any time without explanation or penalty. Your decision whether to participate will not affect your relationship with Bowling Green State University.

Confidentiality Protection:

Your participation in this study will be confidential. Your data will be stored securely on a password-protected computer and the university's secure servers, and only the researcher will have access to it. We will not associate your name with the data. A coding strategy will be used to link your responses across different data points, but your identity will not be revealed in any reports or publications. Any information that could identify you will be stored separately and securely. The data will be kept for three years and then securely deleted

Risks

The risks involved in participation are no greater than those experienced in daily life. We will be asking questions regarding your experiences as an immigrant parent or as a child of an immigrant parent/s from Pakistan in the U.S.

While this study poses minimal physical risk, it is possible that as a participant, you may experience emotional or psychological discomfort when discussing personal experiences or answering questions that may include questions about close relationships and how you have maintained them during your life. If at any time you feel uncomfortable with a question,

you may decline to answer. If you experience any distress, you may leave the study at any time. You may avail any of the online mental health resources and virtual counselling services mentioned below,

Website: **7Cups.com**
Service: Free, anonymous emotional support via trained listeners, with options to connect with licensed therapists.
Contact: Available through their website or app.
Crisis Text Line

Website: **CrisisTextLine.org**
Service: Free, 24/7 crisis counseling via text.
Contact: Text "HELLO" to 741741 for support in the U.S.

National Alliance on Mental Illness (NAMI)
Website: NAMI.org
Service: Provides mental health resources, helplines, and online peer support groups.
Contact: NAMI HelpLine – Call 1-800-950-NAMI (6264) or email info@nami.org

Contact Information

If you have any questions about the study or your participation, please contact me at farooqs@bgsu.edu or 5676983644. You may also contact my advisor, Dr. Sandra Faulkner, at sandraf@bgsu.edu or by phone at 419–372-6525. For questions regarding your rights as a participant, you may contact the Chair of the Bowling Green State University Institutional Review Board at 419-372-7716 or irb@bgsu.edu.

Continuing with this interview indicates consent. By granting verbal permission, you agree to participate in this research and permit the interviewee to record the interview. You acknowledge that you have been informed of the purposes, procedures, risks, and benefits of this study. You have had the opportunity to get answers to all your questions and have been informed that your participation is completely voluntary.

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